

Mengezi Mhlanga

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Analytical and adaptable professional with a multidisciplinary background spanning cybersecurity, public policy, human rights, and strategic communications. Demonstrated ability to interpret complex regulatory environments, conduct in-depth policy and technical research, and communicate findings effectively to diverse audiences. Experienced in stakeholder engagement, digital communication, and collaborative project work. Technically proficient with hands-on knowledge of networking, data privacy, and cloud infrastructure security. Committed to promoting inclusive, evidence-based practices in both private and public sector environments. Bilingual: English (fluent), French (functional).

EDUCATION

Mohawk College of Applied Arts & Technology

Hamilton, Ontario

Advanced Diploma, Networking Engineering & Security Analyst,

September 2022 - Present

- Acquired hands-on experience in managing, protecting, and defending complex IT Infrastructure, both on-premise and in the cloud, utilizing industry-standard tools and methodologies to ensure system security and reliability.
- Strengthened problem-solving and teamwork skills through collaborative projects and simulations, preparing for real-world scenarios in both technical and cross-functional teams environments.

Sir Wilfrid Laurier University

Brantford, Ontario

Bachelor of Arts, Minor in Human Rights

September 2017 - 2022

- Conducted critical analysis of social justice, equity, and public policy issues affecting marginalized communities.
- Participated in research and group initiatives, developing strong skills in communication, advocacy, and policy interpretation.
- Completed coursework focused on legislation, cultural studies, and global human rights frameworks.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Nunavut Arctic College

Iqaluit, Nunavut

Information Technology Specialist

January 2026 – Present

- Provide advanced technical support and operational support for enterprise IT systems, services, and users across NAC locations.
- Administer and support Microsoft 365 services including Teams, SharePoint, Exchange, and user access management.
- Troubleshooting complex incidents escalated beyond Tier 2 and 3, including authentication, printing systems, networking connectivity, and device management issues.
- Support IT governance, security, and compliance initiatives by enforcing access controls, assisting with incident response, and documenting procedures and resolutions.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams to implement new systems, improve service delivery, and support institutional IT projects

Desk Side Support Officer

August 2025 - December 2025

- Delivered Tier 1 and Tier 2 technical support for desktop hardware, software, peripherals, and classroom technology across 36 facilities in Nunavut, ensuring rapid resolution and high client satisfaction.
- Diagnosed and resolved incidents through phone, email, and onsite support, including workstation repair, software installation, bug-fixing, and account administration across multiple platforms.
- Maintained and secured NAC computing environments by monitoring endpoints, reporting risks, participating in security incident reviews, and contributing to mitigation strategies.
- Supported networking, telephony, printing, and lab/classroom systems; performed imaging, scripting, and configuration of laptops/desktops; managed asset distribution, archival, and disposal.

SharpStakes

Toronto, Ontario

Sales Representative

July 2024 - June 2025

- Conducted market and regulatory research to inform business development strategies in a compliance-sensitive industry.
- Delivered strategic recommendations to senior leadership, incorporating stakeholder feedback and risk assessments.
- Strengthened data-driven decision-making and presentation skills in a fast-paced environment.

PROJECTS

Personal Portfolio Website | Independent

- Built a responsive website using HTML and CSS to showcase academic projects and certifications.
- Integrated best practices in accessibility and user-friendly design.

Firewall Configuration Project | Mohawk College

- Configured and managed firewall rules to control inbound/outbound network traffic.
- Conducted penetration testing simulations to verify firewall strength
- Produced a technical report with configuration details and lessons learned.

Wireshark Network Traffic Analysis | Mohawk College

- Captured and analyzed live network traffic using Wireshark.
- Identified common protocols (TCP, HTTP, DNS) and detected suspicious patterns.
- Documented findings and proposed remediation strategies.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Introduction to Cybersecurity** by CISCO *January 2023*
 - Gained foundational knowledge of cybersecurity principles, threats, and vulnerabilities
 - Developed awareness of security policies, legal frameworks, and ethical considerations in digital environments.
 - Explored real-world applications of cybersecurity in business, government, and infrastructure protection
- **Introduction to Data Science** by CISCO *January 2023*
 - Learned key concepts in data analysis, visualization, and interpretation.
 - Gained familiarity with the data science lifecycle, including data collection, cleaning, and modelling.
 - Explored the role of data-driven decision-making in fields such as business intelligence, policy development, and digital marketing.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Language:** Python
- **Web Technologies:** HTML and CSS

- **Tools:** VS Code, Google Colab, Canva, Google Suite,
- **Collaboration & Communication Tools:** Microsoft Teams, Microsoft Entra, Microsoft Admin Center, Signal, FreshService, Azure

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Sir Wilfrid Laurier University

Brantford, Ontario

Student Opportunity for Unity and Leadership Marketing Executive

November 2018 - 2021

- Promoted the vision of diversity and inclusion on the university campus, enhancing awareness and participating through targeted outreach efforts.
- Managed and created comprehensive posting schedules, ensuring timely and relevant content delivery across multiple social media platforms.
- Drove the growth of the initiative's digital presence by developing engaging content that increased followers, viewers, and overall engagement on social media
- Assisted in developing innovative methods of promoting the club's activities and content, leveraging social media analytics to refine and enhance outreach efforts.

Liberty For Youth

Hamilton, Ontario

General Volunteer

July 2019 - August 2023

- Contributed to planning and executing youth mentorship and community engagement events.
- Participated in mentorship programs supporting at-risk youth and contributed to feedback for service improvements.
- Collaborated with teams to support outreach, fostering inclusion and equity.

KEY STRENGTHS

- **Policy Research & Analysis** – Skilled in synthesizing legal, social, and regulatory information into actionable insights.
- **Technical Literacy** - Knowledge of digital security principles, infrastructure protection, and data governance.
- **Communication** - Strong ability to draft clear and persuasive policy briefs, reports, and public materials..
- **Stakeholder** - Experienced in client communication, cross-sector collaboration, and inclusive outreach.
- **Equity & Inclusion Focus** - Committed to integrating social justice principles into policy and organizational practices.